

PARAPHRASE OF TELEGRAM RECEIVED

FROM: AMLEGATION, Bern
TO: Secretary of State
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CONFIDENTIAL

SECTION III

(3) Question was put to Riegner whether payment of hidden funds to relief agency might not expose owners to confiscation or other penalty from Rumanians; and reply was that in Rumania "unlike Switzerland", such matters could be "arranged for".

B. With reference to paragraphs (2) and (4) of Department's telegram, approximately 30,000 Palestine entry permits made available to Jews on basis of British White Paper, according to statement of Riegner. It is the hope of the World Jewish Congress to evacuate this number eventually from Central Europe - 4000 children from Rumania and Bulgaria via Turkey to Palestine - and the congress is currently working on this project. International Red Cross is seeking permission of Rumanian Government to emigrate this number and Rumanian authorities have indicated that they do not oppose such a project in principle. Securing Bulgarian transit and transportation through Turkey is greatest difficulty. Riegner believes negotiations are under way in Turkey for chartering a transport vessel.

HARRISON